

The Story of Glintjaw

A Born Good Side Story

*Eight hundred years before Elias set foot in Tetherpoint Academy,
a worthless little chest changed the world forever.*

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The Incubation of Greed

Era: 4 B.C.A. (Before the Containment Architecture) | Location: Bedlam Box — The Eastern Incubation Vaults

The world was younger then. Before the Wizards Emporium. Before the laws that kept monsters in their place. Before anyone believed the world could ever be safe.

Maelora did not care for peace. She was the God of Chaos, and when the world grew quiet she made something that screamed. She had filled the earth with beasts because she wanted to see what they would do. Some burned. Some poisoned. Some tore mountains apart. Most died quickly. That never bothered her. Failure was only another experiment.

Deep beneath the oldest mountains lay Bedlam Box. The place breathed like something alive. Stone sweated. The walls shifted. Thousands of living sacs hung from the ceiling, each waiting to birth another horror.

Maelora walked among them. Most disappointed her. Then she stopped before a small vault. Inside sat a mimic. It looked like an ordinary chest. Cheap wood. Rusted hinges. Nothing about it was remarkable. Only the strange crystal where its lock should have been watched her as she watched it.

She sighed. "Pathetic."

The chest snapped shut.

She raised one hand. The wheel of affinity turned. Fire. Shadow. Death. Blood. Storm. Madness. Thousands of possibilities spun past before the wheel settled.

Affinity Assigned: Magical Items

She frowned. Then she smiled. "Well."

The mimic stared at the enchanted trinket hanging from her sleeve. The air bent. The ornament tore free and flew straight into its mouth. The little creature clamped down as if the world might steal it back.

Maelora stared. "You little thief."

Then she laughed. The mountain shook with it. Demons fell to their knees. The mimic never looked away from its prize.

"So that's what you are." She crouched beside it. "Glintjaw."

The name fit. Gold appeared across its back teeth. Worthless little caps that shone brighter than they had any right to. The mimic rattled with delight. Its lid clicked again and again like coins spilling across a table. It loved treasure more than food. More than life.

Maelora stood. "Go hoard."

She left the vault. Behind her came a tapping sound. She looked back. The mimic bounced awkwardly across the stone floor after something. Her crystal mallet. It was nothing special to her. Just a tool used to shape monster cores. To Glintjaw it was everything.

He leaped. Missed. Hit the floor. Got back up. Jumped again. Again. Again.

She watched him fail until she grew curious. Finally she lowered the mallet. Glintjaw seized it with both jaws and every leg he had. He pulled with all his strength. The hammer did not move.

She reached down and took it back. "No."

The mimic froze. Then it bit her. Its teeth sank into the finger of the God of Chaos. Silence spread through the vault. No creature had ever done such a thing.

Maelora looked at the bite. Then she laughed harder than before. "You fearless little bastard."

Glintjaw growled around her finger. He did not let go. She held him up and studied him. He was tiny. Weak. Greedy. He had no fear at all.

She offered him the mallet again. This time she let him keep it. He wrapped every limb around the crystal head and refused to let go.

She opened a tear in the world. Beyond it waited a forgotten cave where travelers sometimes searched for easy riches. She tossed him through. He disappeared into the darkness with the hammer locked against his chest. The portal began to close.

Maelora smiled. "Wait there, little Glintjaw. One day someone richer than you will come."

The rift sealed. She never imagined she had just armed the greediest creature in creation.

Glintjaw settled into the dark with his first treasure. It would never be enough.

Chapter Two

The First Hoard

Location: The Caverns of Light

The Caverns of Light had no need for the sun. Crystal veins climbed every wall, bathing the cavern in pale blue and white. Pools reflected the glow until it seemed the whole world shimmered.

Glintjaw noticed none of it. He sat in the middle of the cavern with the crystal mallet clutched against his chest. Every few moments he licked it, then hugged it tighter. It was his. Nothing else mattered.

A faint pulse traveled through the hammer. Glintjaw froze. The crystal began to fade. He bit down harder. The handle slipped through his teeth like mist. “No.” The head disappeared next. He shook it violently. The weapon continued dissolving.

Panic seized him. He bounced across the cavern, slamming into crystal pillars. He snapped wildly at empty air. His little wooden body rattled with desperate fury. The hammer was gone.

Glintjaw shrieked. The echo carried through the cavern.

Three adventurers rounded the bend. A frost mage. A warrior. A holy priest. All wore the bronze crest of beginner adventurers.

“Did you hear that?” the priest asked.

The warrior pointed. “A mimic.”

The mage laughed. “Level one.”

Glintjaw looked up. The warrior meant nothing. The priest meant nothing. Then he saw the mage. Two enchanted rings. A glowing orb floating beside her shoulder. Beautiful. *Mine*.

The mimic charged.

The warrior stepped forward and buried his sword into Glintjaw’s lid. Wood splintered. Health dropped. The priest smirked. “That was easy.”

A bolt of frost struck next. Ice exploded across Glintjaw’s body. Another slash. Another spell. His health plummeted. Seventy percent. Fifty. Thirty.

The mage prepared another Frost Bolt. “Finish it.”

The spell struck. Twenty-five percent.

The world stopped.

WARNING – Unique Artifact Bond Detected. Core Artifact Integration Complete.
Artifact: Incubation Mallet

Passive Skill Unlocked: Magical Absorption (Level 1) – When below 25% Health, hostile magical attacks may be absorbed instead of causing damage. Absorbed mana permanently reshapes the Core Artifact.

The frost surrounding Glintjaw did not melt. It flowed. Blue mana streamed into the center of his body. The adventurers stared. “What...”

The mage fired another Frost Bolt. Instead of exploding, the spell vanished into Glintjaw. Inside his wooden frame, something formed. A crystal handle. Then a head. Not the old hammer. A new one. Forged from frost itself. It glowed with cold blue light.

Glintjaw wrapped his limbs around it. *Mine.*

The mage stumbled backward. “Stop casting!”

Too late. The third Frost Bolt disappeared into the hammer. Its glow intensified. Cold rolled across the cavern floor.

Glintjaw swung. He had no technique. No skill. Only greed. The hammer slammed into the stone. The cavern erupted. Frozen mana exploded outward in every direction. Crystal shards and icy wind engulfed the party.

The warrior froze first. The priest reached for a spell that never came. The mage’s eyes widened as ice crawled over her face. Three statues stood before Glintjaw.

He bounced toward the nearest. Swing. The warrior shattered into glittering fragments. Swing. The priest exploded into frozen dust. Swing. The mage broke apart last.

Two objects clattered onto the stone. A glowing ring. A floating frost orb.

Glintjaw’s crystal eye widened. *Treasure.*

He pounced. The ring dissolved into his body. The orb followed. Mana rushed through his wooden frame.

Items Absorbed: Enchanted Frost Ring, Apprentice’s Frost Orb

New Skills Learned: Frost Bolt (Level 1) – Fire a condensed bolt of freezing mana. Freeze (Level 1) – Briefly immobilizes nearby enemies with magical ice.

Glintjaw looked around the empty cavern. No more treasure. He hugged his glowing hammer. Then he began hopping deeper into the darkness. There would be shinier things ahead.

The Waiting Trap

Location: The Caverns of Light — Side Passage

Two brilliant, azure windows flashed in rapid succession before Glintjaw's central crystal eye, cutting through the dim ambient twilight of the cavern.

Level Up! You have reached Level 2!

Level Up! You have reached Level 3!

Notice: Mimic has evolved through heavy magical saturation. Intelligence has been significantly increased.

The sudden influx of cognitive clarity felt entirely foreign, almost uncomfortable. Thoughts that had previously existed only as base, primal urges — *mine, shiny, eat, hide* — suddenly organized themselves into something sharp, linear, and calculating. The fog of low-tier monstrosity receded. Glintjaw sat completely still on the damp stone floor, deliberately focusing his intent until a detailed status window manifested in his field of vision.

Character Status

Name / Race: Glintjaw / Mimic | Level: 3

HP: 145/145 | Mana: 200/200

STR: 8 | AGI: 7 | INT: 16 | VIT: 12 | WIS: 4 | CHA: 1

Abilities: Magical Absorption (Lv.1), Frost Bolt (Lv.1), Freeze (Lv.1)

With enhanced intelligence came a brand-new instinct. If absorbing raw magic was the catalyst that made him smarter, faster, and more resilient, then wandering the tunnels aimlessly was an inefficient waste of energy. Strategy replaced impulse. He needed to position himself where the magic would inevitably come to him.

Sprouting six stubby, splintered wooden legs from his underbelly, Glintjaw scuttled with quiet purpose toward a narrow, shadow-drenched side passage. He found a recessed alcove near a cluster of dormant mana crystals. With a wet, shifting sound of creaking wood and morphing iron, he tucked his appendages beneath his chassis, settling into the perfect, pristine shape of an abandoned, iron-banded treasure chest. Inside his extradimensional void pocket, his adhesive tongue curled tightly around the handle of his heavy mallet, waiting.

Minutes stretched into an hour. Then, the rhythmic crackle and hum of localized lightning echoed down the main corridor.

An elven male shaman, bearing the distinct, proud stance of a seasoned Level 6 adventurer, strode into the cavern. Three miniature elemental totems floated in a slow orbit around his shoulders, humming with defensive magic. He was systematically clearing the sector, farming rare reagents from the cavern's lesser lightning elementals. Blue sparks danced merrily along his leather bracers as he used a curved dagger to harvest glowing crystal clusters and rare,

static-infused herbs from the rock faces.

Glintjaw did not breathe. He did not twitch. He suppressed the ambient glow of his crystal eye, appearing as nothing more than a forgotten reward left behind by a previous dungeon tier.

The shaman turned the corner, his eyes lighting up instantly as they locked onto the lone chest resting innocently against the far wall.

“Finally,” the elf muttered to himself, a greedy grin breaking across his sharp features. “Something actually worth opening in this dump.”

He sheathed his harvesting dagger and approached with unhurried confidence, entirely misreading the lack of traps on the exterior. The very instant his leather-gloved fingers wrapped around the iron latch of the lid, Glintjaw’s trap sprung.

The lid flew open, revealing rows of jagged, crystalline fangs. With a sickening crunch of fracturing bone, Glintjaw’s jaws snapped shut entirely around the shaman’s right forearm. The elf let out a choked gasp of shock, attempting to yank his limb back, but the mimic’s grip was absolute. With a brutal twist of his wooden chassis, Glintjaw tore the arm completely free at the elbow in a heavy spray of crimson blood.

The shaman screamed — a high, agonizing sound that echoed off the cavern walls. Driven by pure survival instinct, he triggered his instant-cast spells, unleashing a localized Frost Burst closely followed by a roaring Flame Burst. Chilling frost and searing, chaotic fire slammed directly into Glintjaw’s face.

The mimic rocked backward but immediately retaliated. Channeling his newly refined mana, he spat a piercing Frost Bolt directly into the elf’s exposed chest. Before the shaman could recover his footing, Glintjaw triggered Freeze, locking the adventurer’s legs in a thick, crystalline block of magical ice, buying himself a precious second of tactical dominance.

Enraged, pale from blood loss, and panicking, the shaman used his remaining hand to draw a heavy mace, instantly enchanting it with Flametongue Weapon. The weapon’s iron head burst into violent, roaring flames. With desperate, furious strength, he brought the heavy mace down in a sequence of crushing, crackling blows against Glintjaw’s wooden lid.

The structural integrity of the mimic’s body groaned under the assault. His health bar began to plummet rapidly.

Health: 70%... 40%... 20%...

Just as the fatal blow was descending, Glintjaw’s primary defensive passive kicked in: Magical Absorption (Level 1) activated.

Suddenly, the dynamic of the fight shifted completely. Every heavy strike from the flaming mace and every stray bolt of residual lightning the desperate shaman hurled no longer deducted health from Glintjaw’s pool. Instead, the raw elemental energy was redirected inward, feeding directly into

the Incubation Mallet resting within his void pocket. The mallet's crystal head began to glow with blinding intensity, cycling through violent colors — deep electric blue, blinding orange, and finally, a stable, white-hot brilliance.

When the hammer could physically hold no more kinetic and magical energy, Glintjaw unhinged his jaw and swung the weapon outward with all the force his attribute points could muster.

A massive, unstable Pyroblast erupted from the head of the mallet, slamming point-blank into the shaman's chest. The elf barely had time to shriek before the concentrated explosion of fire consumed him entirely. The roaring inferno illuminated the entire side passage, burning the adventurer alive within seconds until nothing remained but blackened soot, charred bone fragments, and scattered, glowing reagents.

The silence of the cave returned. Glintjaw hopped forward on his stubby legs, sniffing the ashes.

A fine silk robe, remarkably preserved at the edges and heavily trimmed with intricate, glowing elemental runes, lay among the debris. Glintjaw pounced on it, dragging the fabric into his maw, dissolving the magical threads directly into his core.

Item Absorbed: Runescribe Shaman's Robe
New Skill Learned: Pyroblast (Level 1) – Hurl a devastating ball of explosive fire. High mana cost.
Level Up! You have reached Level 4! +4 Intelligence +1 Strength +1 Agility +2 Vitality +1 Wisdom

Glintjaw closed his lid tightly, hugging his now comfortably warm, humming mallet to his internal core. He rattled his iron hinges with genuine, bubbling delight. The dark cavern didn't seem so hostile anymore. In fact, it felt a little brighter.

He settled back into his alcove, shifting his form back into the unassuming shape of a treasure chest. There would be more adventurers. There were always more.